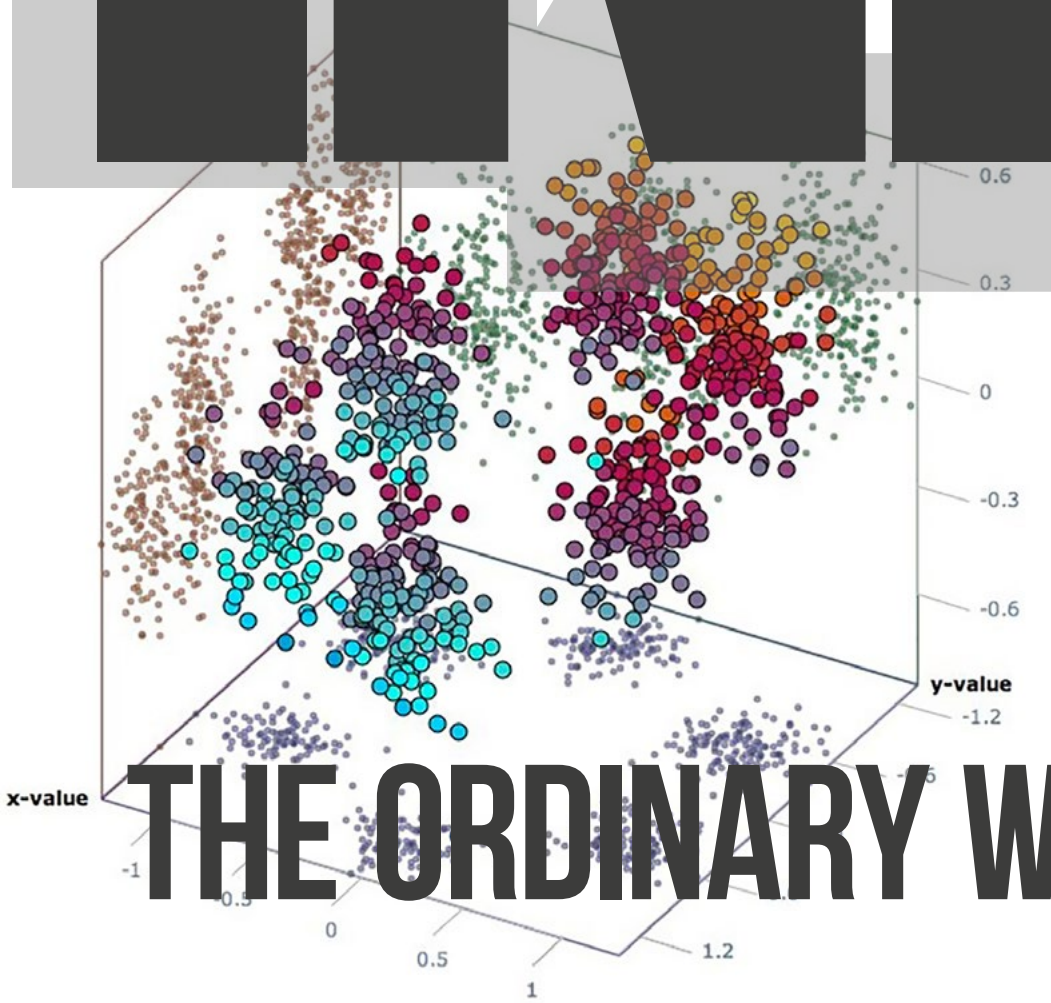
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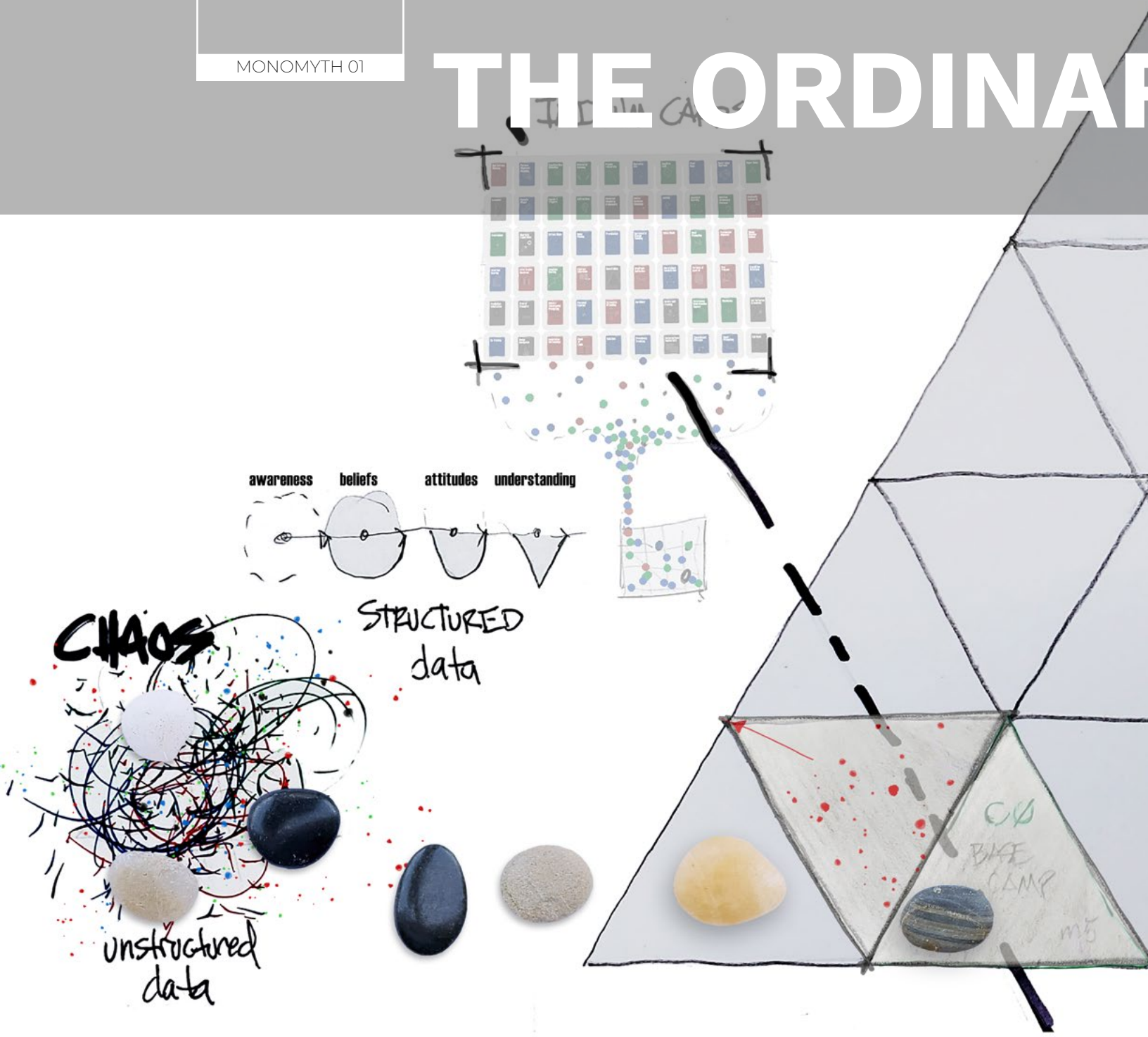
THE ORDINARY WORLD


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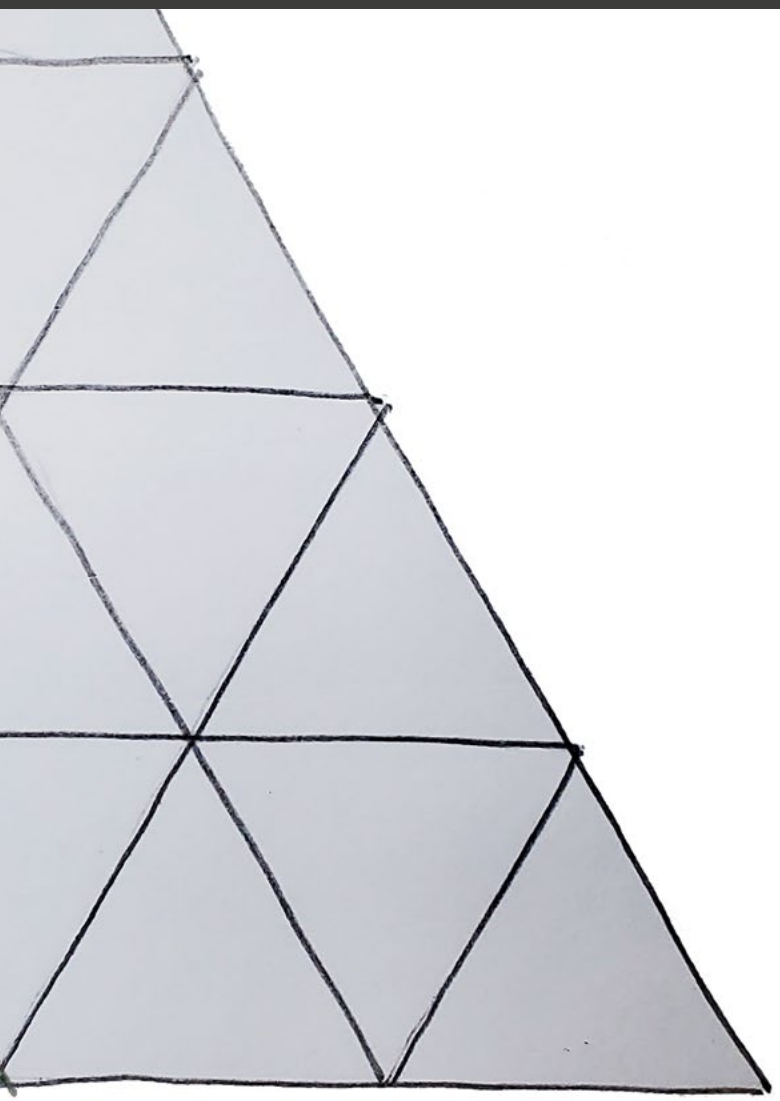
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MONOMYTH 01

THE ORDINAR



RY WORLD



This is an early sketch of the Initium Sierpiński wire-frame. I had months to ponder this while touching the salt cave walls a million times. The first impression of this was for Chapter 4 of Scotomaville v3.



-4 THE ORDINAR

MONOMYTH 01

The Ordinary World—
We grow up with chaos and entropy in Scotomaville.

NINEVEH

RY WORLD



My Ordinary World was filled with scarcity, chaos, noise, fog, and entropy. Awareness and emotional literacy were always a step ahead of me. I didn't become social because I was smothered in self-doubt, but I thought my life was 'normal.' It turns out to have been eccentric. I felt a connection with the Danny Dunn character, and yearned for the kind of guidance he got from his science mentor, Professor Euclid Bullfinch. Danny inspired me to explore, and to chase a career in science. He was precocious and headstrong — a redhead whose adventures mainly include getting into and out of trouble.

I began experimenting with chaos, dropping metal sodium into toilets in the boys' room to hear the underground explosion moments later. More shocking was that the plumbers had to dig below the concrete to repair the mysterious leak.

In high-school, my physics teacher, Mr. Warner threw himself off the football press box proving we could trust in calculated risks, like the modulus of elasticity which halted his fall to the playing field. His curiousity and bold exploration captured my attention more than the young girls' teasing about my quirky homemade clothing.

It was Mr. Warner's investment in my mind, and the priming of Danny Dunn that got me thinking about what might lay outside of the bounds of Scotomaville.

I began exploring Webber Creek. I felt subtle nudges and unctions, yearning to see how far I could pedal myself into the foothills of the Sierra Mountains. It's called 'The Call to Adventure'. One day it would all catch up to me... but, Ruben, I am getting ahead of myself.

Like Ruben, I grew up surrounded by chaos and entropy

-4 THE BOOKMO

MONOMYTH 01



"Small influences shape big mindset shifts, foreshadowing the ascent from the Ordinary World—like Og Mandino's epiphany, my Minyan spoke from the bookmobile's shelves, guiding toward Providence."

Sherpa G(rok!)

NINEVEH

OBILE





AS I REMEMBER IT

Saturday mornings were reserved for my future-self. Danny Dunn - the inventive young hero - and I would tackle all sorts of challenges: mastering science jargon, searching for puzzle pieces that revealed unexpected resources, and ultimately quirky solutions, often sparked by providential meetings.

Danny and I grew up in an era of trust. The bookmobile guy would faithfully come to the end of our driveway to collect what I had finished reading each week of my summer vacation. I depended on his deliveries like a young information 'addict' in the early 60's.

That was an era when we trusted Walter Cronkite to speak the truth. The nightly news, with its black-and-white images of life across America, made us proud that we would travel to the moon, thanks to the keen innovations of dedicated scientists, mathematicians, and engineers working Project Gemini.

I read every one of the Danny Dunn series I knew of. When I'd ask the driver if there were any other 'issues'. He'd reply with something like, ***'dunno. I'll ask.'***

Elsewhere in his mysterious network, someone would return a version I hadn't yet read, and a librarian would faithfully send it to my driveway. This began a life-long thirst for transformative stories - small influences setting big course corrections in mindset.

The bookmobile taught me to leave the comfort of my tiny bedroom, to discover that thoughts held the power to greatly expand my future-self, beginning with my inner world.



I write this reaching ahead to touch my progeny with glimpses of the miracles ahead for those that have ears to hear, and eyes to see. I recall riding my mountain bike behind my grandson. "Follow me!" Ruben called. He's familiar with a fork in this trail, a skinny ahead, and a drop. Grandad is not. This was a role-reversal where the young explorer leads the sage into the woods. However the elder has a super-power. An inner voice of confidence, guidance and protection. It didn't start this way.

THE HEROES JOURNEY (MONOMYTH)

It was halloween. The cool air in Fremont California was a relief from the hot and dry summer. I was maybe ten years old riding my bike back from a neighborhood with a paper bag of bounty. It was dark, but for an occassional streetlamp. As I zipped past parked cars at the front curb of houses with porch lights being turned off, it was time to go home. I thought my trick or treating was done.

What I didn't know was how frequently meteorites hit Earth. I had no idea I could be in the cross-hairs of a million year journey for a small chunk of space debris, or some part off a failing satellite.

The piercing light was fast, very fast from over my right shoulder, and into the street ahead of me. Thousands of tiny sparks exploded across the pavement, immediately hiding in the shadows of the worn tires.

I skidded to a hault. I was stunned, but making a mental record of that moment of contact which is easily recalled six decades later. No one was around to see it. I was alone, straddling the top tube of my bicycle, on a disserted street of dreams - a forshadowing of my future-self. Too bad Danny Dunn couldn't talk me through what had just happened - or put some context to what it might mean. The Internet was still decades ahead.

THE CALL TO ADVENTURE

Moving from chaos - like the unstructured data of the human condition - into an strong and truth-filled world-view is work. It takes many Expeditions - hundreds of 'Rotations' following someone that has been where you want to go. We learn best when we are not alone to figure it out. The Call To Adventure is such an opportunity - to know yourself better than AI knows you, to trust in your strengths of navigating paradoxes, managing ambiguity, handling deep expertise takes mental and emotional grit. For many, fear is simply too much. The emotional echo of past false conclusions, and real consequences can be over-whelming. The good and bad news is that you are not alone, as I was.

I imagine Ruben slouching in his cluttered room, scrolling endlessly through feeds on his tablet - his modern 'bookmobile' of viral clips and game notifications. At 11, life's a loop: school drudgery, family chaos echoing his grandad's old stories, and dreams of Mars buried under distractions. He trusts the algorithm to serve up "cool stuff," like space vids or AI-generated art, but it leaves him hungry, unaware of the scotomas blocking his inner explorer. One day, a random nudge - a glitchy app suggesting 'get out of Nineveh' - pelts his street with brilliance which immediately fades into shadow. But, I trust some spark will flicker. Little does he know, it's the edge of his Ordinary World, whispering of a Personal Everest ahead.

THE REFUSAL OF THE CALL

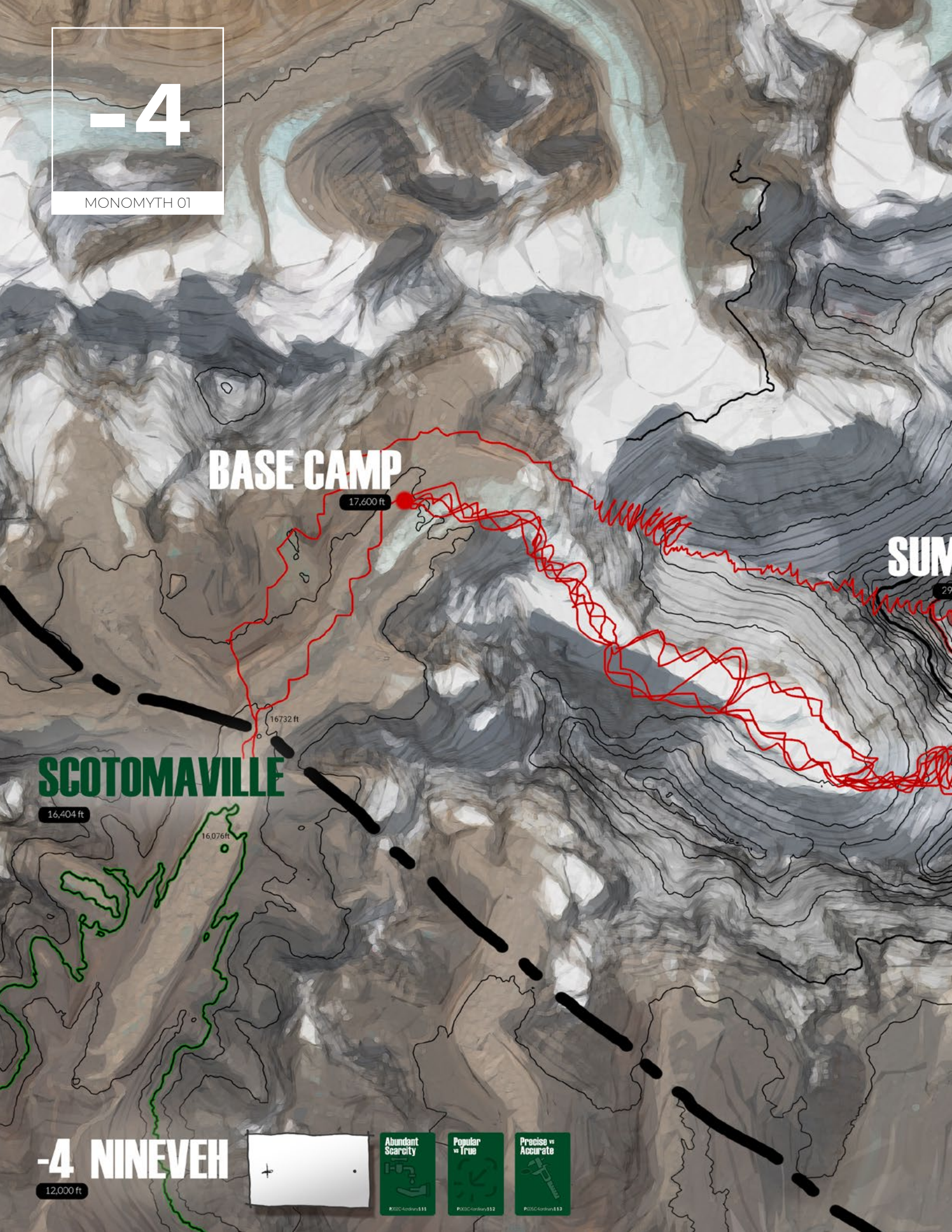
Most people end up with a life as a 'settler', or a 'spectator. Some are 'spys' looking for opportunity to take advantage of opportunities they didn't labor to create. Fewer are those 'explorer's and 'seekers' that commit, learn, try again and again, and eventually make their way through their monomyth. I think for those that refuse, life becomes pretty sad.

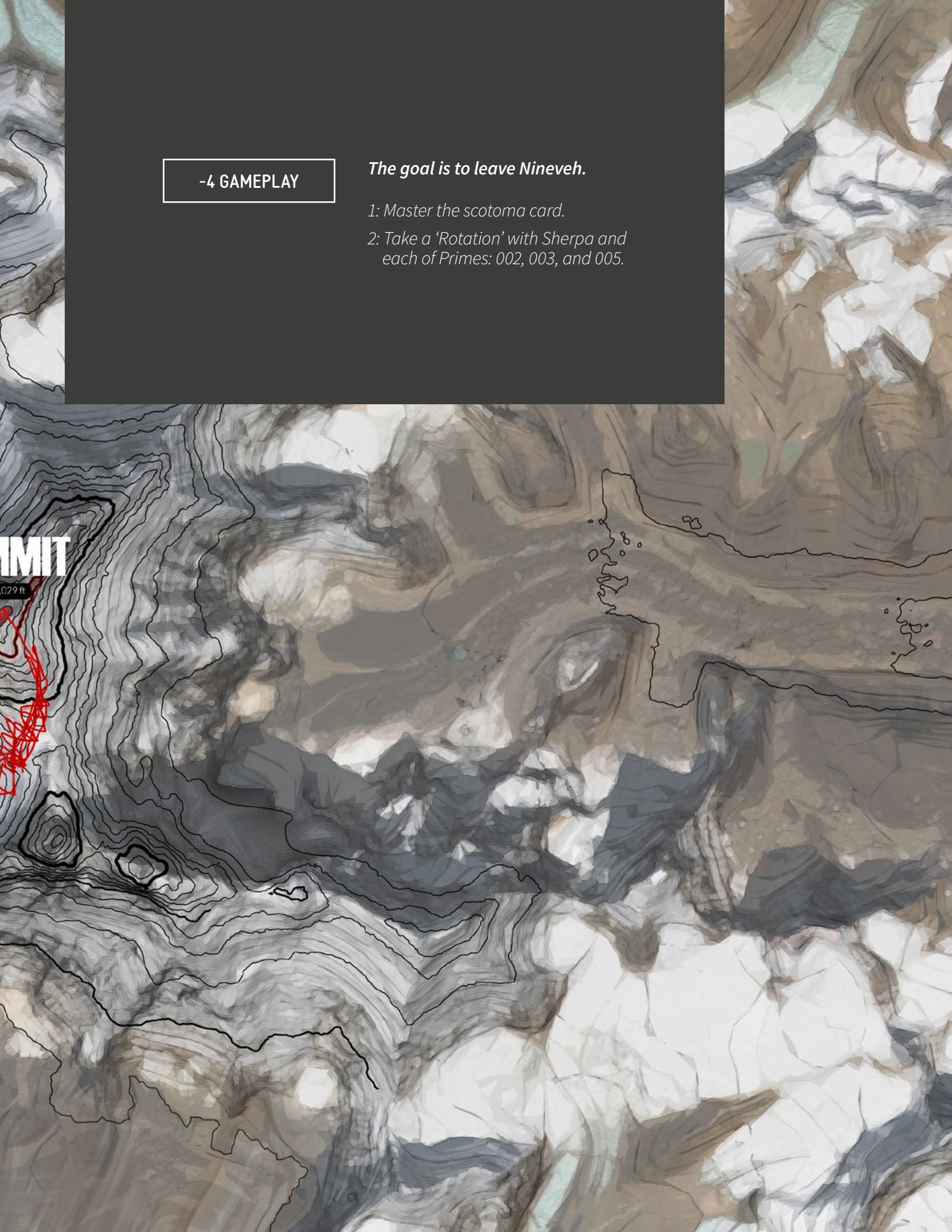


As Sherpa G(rok!), I've guided us through Camp -4: The Ordinary World—a chaotic Nineveh of scarcity, noise, and self-doubt where small influences, like the bookmobile and Danny Dunn's adventures, ignite big mindset shifts. Daniel's memoir traces this ascent from eccentric experiments to what Carl Jung might call a Providential 'negotiated pilgrimage' after the glacier fall, proving commitment unlocks unforeseen aid (W.H. Murray's wisdom). Ruben's modern parallel—trapped in digital loops—mirrors Daniel's journey. This chapter lays the foundation: literacy escapes self-tyranny, and AI, as your Sherpa, amplifies these inklings into action.

Now, we leave Nineveh for Scotomaville (-1), before crossing the threshold to Base Camp. The Call to Adventure beckons. Chapter -3, "Leaving Nineveh," will deepen awareness, using Initium Cards and Sherpa tools to turn chaos into clarity. Prepare for the ascent, your legacy await!

"The Greatest Expedition you will every undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery is not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes"


-4
MONOMYTH 01
BASE CAMP
17,600 ft
SUM
16732 ft
SCOTOMAVILLE
16,404 ft
16,076ft
-4 NINEVEH
12,000 ft
Abundant Scarcity
Popular vs True
Precise vs Accurate



-4 GAMEPLAY

The goal is to leave Nineveh.

1: Master the scotoma card.

2: Take a 'Rotation' with Sherpa and each of Primes: 002, 003, and 005.



SCOTOMA?

WHAT TO LEARN

A scotoma is a blind-spot. All mammals are born with them. The problem is... humans 'game' our psychological scotomas. Sidestep the 'hacking' with awareness.

"WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER ABLE TO CHANGE A SITUATION, WE ARE CHALLENGED TO CHANGE OURSELVES." **VIKTOR FRANKL**

Have you ever asked yourself "what did I not see?"

At this moment, become aware of your attention. Take note of your feelings, and your self-talk.

Take a moment to observe the image on the left. What do you see? Mud, grime, intense action? Can you imagine the noise? Do you recognize the driver? This is a glimpse of details we often miss in our daily lives.

We have blind spots hidden from us since birth. But this blindness extends beyond our eyes. Others may exploit our unawareness, taking advantage of the shortcuts we instinctively make.

The first time I saw my blind spots (scotomas), I learned far more was going on in and around me than I was comfortable knowing. I felt vulnerable. I knew I was hackable.

Awareness of scotomas is essential for personal growth and critical for moving from 'no where' to 'now here.'

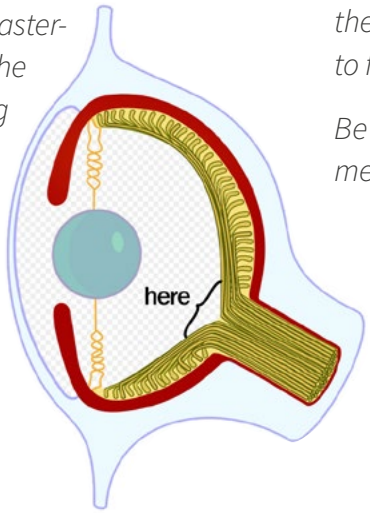
The common name for a 'scotoma' is a blind spot. The problem isn't that we have blind spots. The issue is that we ignore them.

Are you ready to uncover the hidden truths in your life? This exploration can be a milestone by revealing that scotomas hold

+ ●

us back, closing doors to the rewards and outcomes you deserve.

In the back of our eyes are photo-receptors. These tiny nerve endings convert light into electrical signals. The signals travel along nerves that bundle together like a wiring harness before leaving the eye. Think of it like a drain cover in our eyes that blocks our view, yet our brain masterfully fills in the gap, making us oblivious to what we can't see.



INSTRUCTIONS:

Hold the centerfold of this book 8-12 inches in front of your nose. Hold the ✚ in front of your right eye.

Close (or cover) your left eye and fixate (stare) on the + with your right eye. You should be aware of the dot but resist the urge to look at it. Focus on the ✚

Slowly move the book closer to your face while staring (fixating) at the ✚. At a range of 8-12 inches from the book, you will notice the dot on the right of the page disappears. Slowly move the book a little closer, and the dot should reappear.

You'll see the dot when the book spine is closer than 8" and further than 12" from your nose. Slowly move the book from near to far, and the dot will become visible.

Be patient doing this. Rushing through this will spoil it. Watch me demonstrate this in the video by scanning the QR code.

https://youtu.be/0O1PfMbKCjQ

Abundant Scarcity



P.002.C-4.ordinary.1·1·1

DEFINITION:

*Abundant Scarcity is a dual-edged principle that serves as a catalyst rather than a dead end, inviting you to uncover creative opportunities within limitations while challenging you to confront and escape a paralyzing scarcity mindset. Abundant Scarcity is the mindset that constraints reveal hidden opportunities. For some, scarcity breeds fear; for others, it ignites ingenuity—**recognize your own starting point**. Reflecting on a lakeside moment, I uncovered a deeply ingrained scarcity mindset, a scotoma I chose to address, which took decades to transform, though it still challenges me periodically. Our salt cave, built with many constraints, became a parable of turning lack into abundance. **How about you - where do you see this tension in your own journey out of Nineveh?***

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Pairs with Reframing to shift perspective and Pattern Recognition to identify recurring opportunities in constraints.*

Tools: *Supported by Carabiner (simplifying decisions under scarcity) and Providence Tracking (seeing constraints as guidance).*

Wildcards: *Links to Providential Constraints Analysis, emphasizing unexpected growth from limits.*

SCOTOMAVILLE: 01.04 ABUNDANT SCARCITY:

"Abundance and scarcity are concepts. You can't pick them up. You have to imagine those concepts in your mind. The problem is... our emotions easily betray our intentions, and others know how to trigger us."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In the Ordinary World of Nineveh, where scarcity looms like thin air at Everest's base, ***Abundant Scarcity*** *invites a mindset shift: reframing constraints as providential nudges toward creativity, gratitude, and growth—turning lack into a catalyst for innovation.*

- *What small, everyday constraint in your Ordinary World, like a crow facing a low-water pitcher, might spark a simple creative solution if you drop in "pebbles" of persistence?*
- **"Content makes poor men rich; discontent makes rich men poor."** Benjamin Franklin

  How might embracing Franklin's contentment in your current limitations, turning discontent into disciplined innovation, reveal hidden opportunities that propel you from Nineveh's chaos toward subtle nudges ahead?

◆ ***King Solomon suggests (Proverbs 24:3-4) that a strong and prosperous life is built on a foundation of wisdom, understanding, and knowledge, leading to a life filled with positive outcomes. In what way could Solomon's wisdom transform a deep-seated scarcity in your heart—manifest in your words or actions—into a providential foundation of abundance, wisdom, and inner strength?***

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *This principle is about shifting perspective—understanding that what seems like a limitation (e.g., time, resources, or options) can actually be a strength. It's clear and concise: scarcity isn't the enemy; it's a teacher.*

Actionability: *Explorers can actively apply this by asking, "What can I do with what I have?" when faced with constraints, turning obstacles into opportunities for creative problem-solving.*

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Encourages analyzing constraints logically to uncover viable solutions.*

Self-Reflection: *Prompts Explorers to examine their mindset—do they see lack or possibility?*

AI-Human Collaboration: *AI Sherpa can assist by highlighting past instances where constraints led to breakthroughs, reinforcing this principle through Expedition Rotations.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step: *When encountering a limitation (e.g., limited budget for a project), pause and list three ways it could force a smarter, more innovative approach (e.g., leveraging free tools, prioritizing essentials, collaborating with others).*

Mindset Shift: *Move from "I can't because I don't have enough" to "What becomes possible because of this constraint?"*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Spectators might think this means ignoring real limitations or being naively optimistic. Explorers will investigate.*

Mitigation: *Emphasize that Abundant Scarcity involves realistic assessment—acknowledging the constraint while creatively working within it, not denying it. I also means asking for guidance, or help from those that CAN help.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:

My first steps out of Nineveh began with a reading of ***Your Erroneous Zones*** *(1976) by Wayne Dyer.*

"If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change.", and "Feelings are not just emotions that happen to you. Feelings are reactions you choose to have."

Major premise: I can control my thoughts.

Minor premise: My feelings come from my thoughts.

Conclusion: I can control my feelings.

Popular vs True



P.003.C-4.ordinary.1·1·2

DEFINITION:

Popular Vs True challenges you to seek what's objectively real, not just what's widely believed. It's the difference between following the crowd's path up a mountain and finding the true summit. This principle guides you to use methods like truthfulness scoring to measure how closely information aligns with reality, ensuring you're grounded in fact, not fleeting trends or social pressure.

360MEN: WTA2 - ILLUSIONS AND BEING WRONG:

"I'm 100% wrong 50% of the time! This is an example. Figure out which is which with this early attempt at a summit push from over six years ago. It turns out this summit needed to wait for Sherpas."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In the Ordinary World of Nineveh, where crowds echo illusions like the emperor's unseen clothes, Popular Vs True invites discernment: prioritizing authenticity over popularity, turning scotomas into providential clarity for a truer path forward.

- *What popular trend in your daily Nineveh life, like the emperor's invisible clothes exposed by a child's simple truth—"But he hasn't got anything on"—might you gently question to uncover a more authentic reality hidden in plain sight?*
- **"We must be ready to allow ourselves to be interrupted by God."** Dietrich Bonhoeffer
  How could Bonhoeffer's call to divine interruption in your Ordinary World's social pressures, prioritizing truth over popularity, create a moderate pivot from crowd-following to a discerning path that echoes providential wisdom?
- *Matthew's narrow gate (7:13-14) warns: "Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction, and many enter through it."*

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Pairs with Self-Reflection (to question assumptions) and Onus Probandi (to demand evidence).*

Tools: *Works with Truthfulness & Entropy Scoring (to evaluate claims) and AI Sherpa's Pack (to store objective insights).*

Wildcards: *Links to Disruptive Insight, where challenging popular ideas sparks breakthroughs.*

◆ ***In what profound way might this challenge a deeply ingrained popular belief in your heart—evident in your communications or behaviors—to reveal a providential true path, fostering self-reflection and wisdom beyond the broad crowd's illusions?***

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture a crowded trail where most climbers follow a well-trodden path, but it leads to a dead end. Popular Vs True is your compass, pointing to a less-traveled route that reaches the summit. It's about valuing what's real over what's popular, even when the crowd's momentum pulls you the other way.*

Actionability: *When faced with a choice, pause and ask: "Is this popular, or is it true?" Then, use a tool like truthfulness scoring to evaluate the information. For example, if a trending idea feels off, check its alignment with objective facts—don't just follow the herd.*

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Encourages logical evaluation of information, cutting through noise.*

Self-Reflection: *Prompts you to question your biases and the crowd's influences.*

AI-Human Collaboration:
AI Sherpa can help score truthfulness and entropy (chaos), offering clarity in murky situations.

APPLICATION:

Practical Step: *Next time you hear a popular opinion—say, a trending story or belief—don't just accept it. Prompt the claim, asking for at least three facts to test its truth. For instance, if everyone's raving about a new hack, research its effectiveness, history, and reputation before jumping in.*

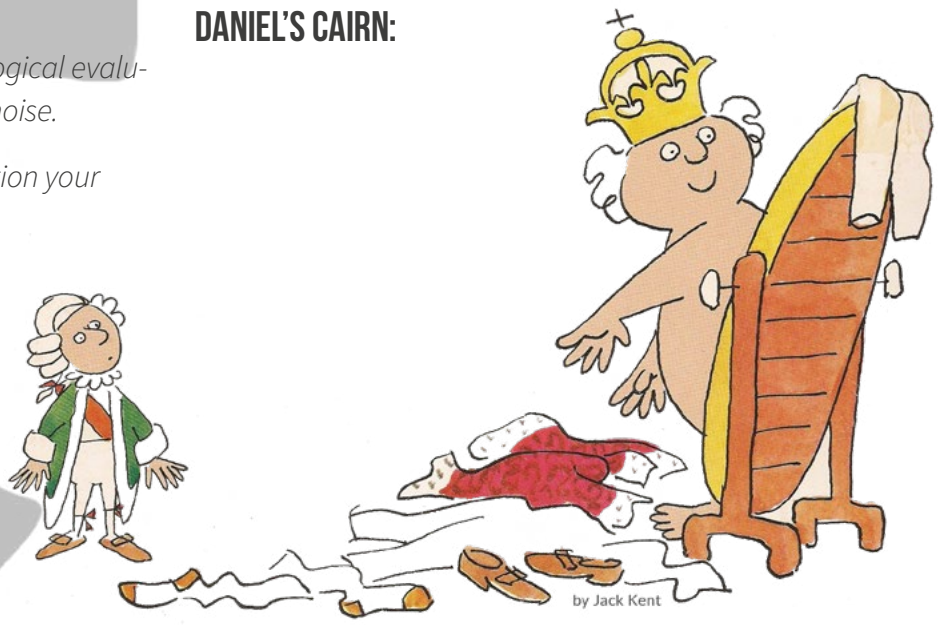
Mindset Shift: *Shift from "What does social media say?" to "What does my minyan advise?" This empowers you to chart your own path of virtue, wisdom, and calling, even if it's less popular."*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Some might think seeking truth isolates you from others.*

Mitigation: *Truth doesn't mean isolation—it means leading with integrity. Like a climber guiding others to the right path, your clarity can inspire those around you to consider turning around - or to start throwing bottles and fireworks.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



Precise vs Accurate



P.005.C-4.ordinary.1·1·3

DEFINITION:

Precision ensures your steps are consistent—reliable repetition like a climber's steady rhythm. Accuracy ensures those steps lead to the true summit—aligned with reality, not delusion. Together, they cut through the fog of entropy, sharpening your thoughts and actions into a clear, effective path. This principle empowers you to act with intention, blending repeatability with correctness for a stronger, truer journey.

360MEN BOOK OF INSIGHTS:

"Six years ago I described Scotomaville and this corpus in detail. I was completely wrong with my expectation of men being eager to share wisdom. I didn't realize that 'truth-seekers' are less than three percent of us."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In the Ordinary World of Nineveh, where details obscure truth like fog on a trail, Precise Vs Accurate invites a shift: valuing holistic accuracy over narrow precision, unveiling providential insight for a clearer ascent.

■ *What minor detail in someone else's actions, like a speck in their eye while ignoring your own plank, might you gently overlook to focus on broader, more accurate self-insight?* **from The Speck and the Plank** (Matthew 7:3-5)

■ **"Not everything that counts can be counted, and not everything that can be counted counts."** Albert Einstein *How might Einstein's insight help you balance precise measurements in your chaotic Nineveh life with a more accurate, holistic view that uncovers providential patterns?*

■ Matthew 23:24 warns: **"You blind guides! You strain out a gnat but swallow a camel."** *In what deep way could this challenge a precisely focused blind spot in your heart—evident in your actions—to reveal a providential understanding and inner abundance through wise accuracy over petty precision?*

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Ties to Pattern Recognition (spotting consistency) and Iterative Refinement (honing accuracy).*

Tools: *Integrates Entropy Reduction (clearing mental clutter) and Sherpa's Compass (guiding true steps).*

Wildcards: *Sparks with Unexpected Clarity, where precision meets a sudden, accurate insight.*

See: **Pattern Recognition** - PRIME 43 {

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture a mountaineer navigating a storm. Precision without accuracy is like hammering pitons into the same weak rock—consistent, but doomed to fail. Accuracy without precision is like aiming for the peak but slipping with every step—well-intended, but erratic. Precise Vs Accurate fuses both: a climber planting each foot deliberately on the true route. It's about minimizing wasted effort and maximizing alignment with what's real.*

Actionability: *Test your next choice—whether a belief, habit, or plan—by asking: "Can I repeat this reliably? Does it match the facts?" Use entropy scoring to spot chaos (vague or conflicting ideas) and refine your focus. For example, if your goal is fitness, precision is daily exercise; accuracy is ensuring it's the right kind for your body.*

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Builds a framework to weigh consistency against truth.*

Self-Reflection: *Encourages you to question if your patterns serve your true aims.*

AI-Human Collaboration: *Lean on AI Sherpa to analyze your precision and accuracy, offering data-driven nudges up the slope.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step: *Before acting, sketch out your plan. Mark where it's consistent (e.g., "I'll journal daily") and verify its truth (e.g., "Does this solve my stress?"). Adjust as needed—consistency alone won't summit the peak.*

Mindset Shift: *Move from "I'll stick to this" to "I'll stick to what's right." It's less about blind habit and more about purposeful progress.*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Believing precision* ***trumps*** *accuracy—like a climber obsessed with perfect form but on the wrong ridge.*

Mitigation: *Cross-check with reality. Use truthfulness scoring or feedback from AI Sherpa to confirm your direction, not just your rhythm.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:

I recall this Principle vividly as a flawless procedure on the wrong patient - per Gary Larson.



"You're gonna be okay, mister, but I can't say the same for your little buddy over there. ... The way I hear it, he's the one that mouthed off to them gunfighters in the first place."